

3.8.1 The briefs

To complete the NEA, students must independently create a media product in response to a brief set by AQA. AQA will release five briefs on 1 March in the year preceding the exam via Secure Key Materials. These briefs will change **annually**. The briefs will be linked to the GCSE Media Studies CSPs. AQA will specify the media form and the intended audience for the media product. The media product that is devised and realised by the student must communicate meaning to a specified audience and must draw on what they know and understand about the theoretical framework of media language and representation.

Students will submit:

- a Statement of Intent on the form supplied with the NEA brief
- a media product.

The [Marking criteria](#) (page 23) detail what students will be expected to demonstrate and provide evidence of when completing the NEA task. Additional, task-specific indicative content will be issued with each of the briefs. Please refer to [Non-exam assessment administration](#) (page 31) for more information about the instructions for conducting the NEA.

3.8.1.1 The Statement of Intent

Students must complete a Statement of Intent that outlines their aims for their media product. This must be submitted to AQA with the media product.

This Statement of Intent should be a maximum of 300 words long and it should be submitted to the teacher no later than 1 April in the year of assessment. The template for the Statement of Intent will be supplied by AQA in the NEA Student Booklet along with the briefs.

3.8.1.2 Size and duration of products

Each brief will specify the required length, amount or duration of the media product that must be created.

3.8.1.3 Unassessed participants

Students must complete an individual media production. Students may, however, use unassessed participants to:

- appear in their media products
- operate equipment under the direction of the assessed student.

All unassessed participants involved in the products must be listed on the Candidate Record Form. Assessed students can only be credited for work they have undertaken themselves or has been completed under their direction. Students and teachers will be required to sign the Candidate Record Form to confirm that this is the case.

Credit can only be given for contributions made by unassessed participants under the clear direction of the assessed student. Details of what each of the unassessed participants contributed to the product and how the assessed student directed that contribution should be listed on the Candidate Record Form.

3.8.1.4 Time spent on NEA

There is no limit to the amount of time that students can spend on their NEA but we recommend they spend around 30 hours on the physical creation of their products. It should be noted that excessive time spent on this component in the classroom could be detrimental to the overall attainment of the students. Teachers should strike a balance between the completion of the NEA and preparation for the examined components. Additionally, demonstration of knowledge and understanding of the theoretical framework is key to success in the NEA so time spent teaching the framework will inform the NEA products.

3.8.1.5 Use of non-original material

With the exception of musical performances, students should not use any non-original material in their media products. All images, footage and text is to be created by the student. If a student does use any non-original images, footage or text, they should be aware that their marks will be limited

by the marking criteria (see [Guidance on applying the marking criteria](#) (page 23)). They must acknowledge any non-original material on the Candidate Record Form.

Students do not have to write and record their own musical performances, either to use as part of a soundtrack or in a music video. Musical tracks that they use should be acknowledged on the Candidate Record Form.

3.8.1.6 Websites and video games

For briefs where website or video game creation is required, students do not need to be able to code. Students can use website design apps, online templates and game design software. Students are responsible for the design of the website or game and the content (such as language, images, audio-visual material) must be created by the student. Students must acknowledge any software or templates which have been used on the appropriate Candidate Record Form.